

GLOBAL WEEK AHEAD

The weekend companion to your Daily Need to Know

Everything coming up. Week of Mon Aug 3. All times GMT+8.

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Setup snapshot — where we closed Friday

Wall Street rallied into the July close: the **S&P 500 +0.7%**, **Nasdaq +1.0%** and **Dow +0.53%** as **Amazon (AWS +37%)** led a tech rebound and the **Fed held** less-hawkishly-than-feared on Wed/Thu. But bond yields kept climbing, **Apple -7.2%** on a China miss, and gold/silver/oil sold off intraday. It was a bounce off a violent late-July unwind, not an all-clear.

Instrument	Fri close (Jul 31)	1-day	Into Monday — what to watch
S&P 500	7,489.72	+0.7%	Sits near top of Hedgeye range; upside thinner than downside
Nasdaq Composite	25,373.85	+1.0%	Bearish TREND intact — Day-1 bounce must prove itself
Dow Jones Ind.	52,485.03	+0.53%	4th straight winning month; cyclical firming
US 10Y yield	≈4.67%	rising	Yields the pressure valve; a break >4.71% pinches multiples
US 2Y yield	≈4.29%	rising	Fed on hold — hike scare, not cut, was priced last week
DXY (US\$ index)	≈99.8	-0.2%	Bullish TREND; range 99.76–102.01
Gold	≈\$4,110	-1.2%	Held the \$4,000 line; bearish immediate-term TREND
Silver	≈\$58.01	-1.7%	Range 55–60; still a high-beta inflation proxy
Brent crude	≈\$89.57	+0.6%	Hormuz premium; OPEC+ decides Sunday
WTI crude	≈\$84.23	+0.8%	Bullish TREND, wide 79–93 range = the swing factor
Bitcoin	≈\$63,829	-1.4%	Slipped toward \$63k; ETH bearish, risk-off tell

Index closes are official. Yields, gold, silver, oil and bitcoin are Friday levels (some intraday) — verify live before acting.

TL;DR — the week in three sentences

This is a jobs-week, earnings-heavy tape sitting on top of a live oil shock: **Friday's July payrolls (Fri 20:30)** is the single print that defines the week, with **ISM Manufacturing (Mon)**, **ISM Services + ADP (Wed)** as the build-up. **OPEC+ meets Sunday** while the **US–Iran / Strait of Hormuz** conflict keeps crude — and therefore the inflation path — on a knife's edge. Earnings peak with **Palantir (Mon)**, **AMD & Caterpillar (Tue)**, **Disney & Eli Lilly (Wed)**, and Hedgeye's Nowcast has just flipped to **August #Quad3** (inflation re-accelerating) — the map says keep fading crowded AI/Tech into Energy, Healthcare and REITs.

The big picture — what to watch

1. Payrolls Friday is the whole week's fulcrum.

June was a soft +57k with unemployment at 4.2%. After a Fed that stayed on hold (and even flirted with a hike), a hot number revives the higher-for-longer/inflation fear while a cold one revives growth-scare/recession talk. Either tail is a problem for a market priced for a soft landing.

Watch: A print with a rising unemployment rate is the more dangerous surprise into **#Quad3** — it pairs slowing growth with re-accelerating inflation. Keep dry powder for the 20:30 release.

2. Oil is the macro swing factor — and it has two catalysts this weekend.

Brent ≈\$89, WTI ≈\$84 with a wide bullish range (WTI 79–93). The **US–Iran conflict / Strait of Hormuz** crisis keeps a war premium in crude even as tankers resume transit, and **OPEC+ meets Sunday Aug 2** to set September output (August was a +188k bpd hike).

Watch: Crude is the transmission line into the whole **#Quad3** thesis. An OPEC+ hold or Hormuz escalation that lifts oil = long Energy (XLE/CRAK) keeps working; a supply surprise that cracks oil would relieve the inflation trade fast.

3. The AI/momentum unwind: crash → bounce → then?

July was the worst month for levered-consensus hedge-fund positioning since 2023 — TMT Memory **–30.5%**, high-beta momentum **–30.9%**, AI Data Centers **–19.4%**. Friday was Day-1 of a bounce (AMZN, MSFT), but Nasdaq and Tech (XLK) TREND signals are still **bearish**.

Watch: A bounce that fails at the TRADE momentum level (XLK ≈\$180) is a re-short signal; a close back above TREND stops you out. Don't confuse a Day-1 rip with a trend reversal.

4. Earnings breadth test beyond mega-cap tech.

With Alphabet/Amazon/Microsoft/Apple behind us, the baton passes to **Palantir** (AI-sentiment bellwether), **AMD** (AI silicon), **Caterpillar** (global industrial + tariff read), **Eli Lilly** (obesity franchise) and **Disney**. The market wants proof the rally can broaden.

Watch: PLTR Tue-morning HK time sets the AI mood; a soft AMD/PLTR guide would re-arm the Tech-unwind, while strong CAT/industrials support the rotation-into-cyclicals story.

5. Tariffs back on the front burner.

The **Aug 1 reciprocal-tariff deadline** has fresh country rates taking effect (recent deals cut India to ~18%, Taiwan to ≤15%). New effective rates land just as earnings guidance is being set.

Watch: Tariff headlines are a margin- and inflation-story at once — watch industrial and retail guidance (CAT, MCD) for cost-pass-through language.

6. Central banks step back — the data leads.

No Fed and no ECB this week. With policy on hold, **hard data (ISMs, payrolls)** and oil — not central-bank speak — will drive rates and the dollar.

Watch: A rising 10Y (range 4.59–4.71) is the equity-multiple pressure valve; a break above 4.71 is the tell that bonds, not earnings, set the tape.

Economic calendar — the week ahead (GMT+8)

Times converted to GMT+8. Source calendar quotes GMT; confirm live before the print.

Day / Time	Event	Prev / Consensus	Why it matters
MONDAY, AUGUST 3			
09:45	China RatingDog (Caixin) Manufacturing PMI	prev 51.7	First read on China factory momentum; sets Asia/commodity-FX tone
14:00	Germany retail sales	prev +1.1% m/m	Euro-area consumer pulse
14:30	Switzerland CPI	prev 0% m/m	SNB easing bias input
22:00	US ISM Manufacturing PMI (Jul)	prev 53.3	Growth/inflation read into payrolls week; sub-50 hits USD
TUESDAY, AUGUST 4			
Wed 06:45	New Zealand employment / unemployment (Q2)	prev 5.3%	NZD driver; RBNZ input
WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 5			
09:45	China RatingDog (Caixin) Services PMI	prev 54.1	Services still the stronger side of China's economy

Day / Time	Event	Prev / Consensus	Why it matters
20:15	US ADP private payrolls (Jul)	prev +98k (Jun)	Payrolls appetizer — often moves the tape
22:00	US ISM Services PMI (Jul)	prev 54.0	~80% of US GDP; prices-paid sub-index is the #Quad3 tell
THURSDAY, AUGUST 6			
09:30	Australia trade balance	prev -A\$3.0bn	AUD / China-demand proxy
11:00	RBNZ inflation-expectations survey (Q3)	prev 2.53%	Feeds NZ rate expectations
17:00	Eurozone retail sales	prev +0.2% m/m	Euro-area demand check
~20:00	Bank of England decision (tentative — see CB section)	3.75%	Traditional early-Aug MPC slot; VERIFY date
FRIDAY, AUGUST 7			
20:30	US Non-Farm Payrolls / Unemployment / Avg Hourly Earnings (Jul)	prev +57k • 4.2% • +0.3%	THE event of the week — defines rates, USD and risk
20:30	Canada employment (Jul)	prev 6.5%	CAD driver alongside oil

Central banks & policy events

A deliberately quiet week for the majors — which throws the weight onto the data. **The Fed held** at its Jul 29–30 meeting (a surprise-hike scare, not a cut, was the market's fear as oil re-accelerated), and there is **no ECB meeting** this week.

- **Bank of England** — the traditional early-August MPC (Thursday Aug 6 slot) may land this week and one week-ahead preview flagged a possible cut from 3.75%; however, the Bank's own published 2026 calendar I reviewed lists the next decision as Sep 17. **TENTATIVE — verify the date and confirm before positioning.**
- **RBNZ** — no rate decision, but the **Q3 inflation-expectations survey (Thu 11:00)** is a live input for the NZD and the next RBNZ move.
- **RBA** — no decision this week; the next RBA meeting is **Aug 11–12 (statement Aug 11)** — a near-horizon preview item, not this week's.

Watch: With policy on hold everywhere, the **US 10Y and oil** are doing the tightening. Rates, not central-bank guidance, are the risk this week.

Earnings on deck

Peak earnings continues, with the leadership test shifting beyond mega-cap tech. Report times are US sessions; HK-time equivalents noted where flagged.

Day	Companies	What the market wants to see
Mon Aug 3	Palantir (PLTR) — after US close (~Tue 05:00 HK)	AI-sentiment bellwether: commercial-US growth + guide to justify the multiple
Tue Aug 4	Caterpillar (CAT), Merck (MRK), McDonald's (MCD), Pfizer (PFE) — BMO; AMD, Amgen (AMGN) — AMC	CAT = global industrial + tariff read; AMD = AI/data-center silicon demand and margins
Wed Aug 5	Eli Lilly (LLY), Disney (DIS), Novo Nordisk (NVO), CVS — BMO; Uber (UBER), Shopify (SHOP), AppLovin (APP), Western Digital (WDC), SanDisk (SNDK)	LLY/NVO = obesity-drug trajectory; DIS = parks + streaming profitability; consumer resilience via UBER/SHOP
Thu–Fri	Balance of S&P 500 reporters (financials, industrials, consumer)	Breadth: can non-mega-cap earnings carry the rotation?

Watch: PLTR and AMD are the AI-unwind's live wires — a soft guide re-arms the momentum-crash trade; strong CAT/industrials support the rotation into cyclical and value.

Catalysts & events

- **OPEC+ meeting — Sunday Aug 3 (Aug 2 US)** — sets September output. August was a +188k bpd hike; with the Hormuz premium in crude, the size of any further unwind of cuts is the key oil catalyst as this note lands.
- **US reciprocal tariffs** — fresh country rates effective around the **Aug 1 deadline** (recent deals: India ~18%, Taiwan ≤15%). A margin- and inflation-story at once.
- **Peak earnings week** — the single biggest micro catalyst; see the Earnings section.
- **US July payrolls (Fri)** — the macro event; see calendar.

Read: Two weekend oil catalysts (OPEC+ and Hormuz headlines) mean the **Monday Asia open can gap on crude** before a single US data point prints. Position sizing over the weekend matters.

Rates, currencies & commodities — levels & drivers

Rates

US 10Y ≈4.67% inside a **4.59–4.71** immediate-term range with a bullish (higher-yield) TREND; 2Y ≈4.29%. A decisive break >**4.71%** is the equity-multiple pressure valve into payrolls.

Currencies

DXY ≈99.8, bullish TREND, range **99.76–102.01**. A hot payrolls + sticky ISM-prices combo argues for dollar strength; watch USD/JPY into the Asia bounce and CAD against oil.

Commodities

WTI **79–93** (bullish) is the widest, most important range on the board — the **#Quad3 engine**. Gold **3,991–4,139** (bearish immediate-term, but \$4,000 held), silver **55–60** (bearish), copper **6.19–6.59** (bullish). Nat gas **2.61–2.93** (bearish).

Watch: Oil up + dollar up + yields up is the classic **#Quad3** cocktail — it squeezes long-duration Tech and rewards Energy, value and defensives.

Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Regime — Hedgeye's US Nowcast just shifted from **July #Quad4** (growth and inflation both slowing — the month that punished levered momentum, memory and AI exposures) to **August #Quad3**: growth still slowing while **inflation re-accelerates month-over-month**, driven by the breakout in oil and major commodities. The playbook: new value in **Energy (XLE, CRAK)**; stay long **GARP Software, Healthcare (XLV), REITs (XLRE)** and defensives; keep fading crowded growth/AI and short Korea (EWY).

Immediate-term Risk Range™ signals (from the Jul 31 Early Look, "Crash, Bounce, Then?") — the map for the week:

Instrument	Risk range	TREND
UST 10Y Yield	4.59 – 4.71	BULLISH
High Yield (HYG)	78.97 – 79.76	NEUTRAL
IG Corp Bonds (LQD)	105.7 – 107.3	BEARISH
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,316 – 7,538	BULLISH
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	24,314 – 25,569	BEARISH
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,904 – 2,990	BULLISH
Technology (XLK)	165 – 181	BEARISH
Health Care (XLV)	159 – 168	BULLISH
Real Estate (XLRE)	44.99 – 46.40	BULLISH
Volatility (VIX)	15.77 – 20.56	BEARISH
US Dollar (DXY)	99.76 – 102.01	BULLISH
WTI Crude Oil	79.27 – 92.90	BULLISH
Natural Gas	2.61 – 2.93	BEARISH
Gold	3,991 – 4,139	BEARISH

Instrument	Risk range	TREND
Copper	6.19 – 6.59	BULLISH
Silver	55 – 60	BEARISH

Source: Hedgeye Early Look, Keith McCullough, 31 Jul 2026. TREND = intermediate-term signal (bullish/bearish/neutral).

Where we sit / what would change the regime

The S&P closed 7,489 — near the top of its 7,316–7,538 range (upside ~+0.6% vs downside ~-2.3%), an asymmetric, sell-the-rip setup. Nasdaq's bearish TREND and Tech (XLK) bearish signal say Friday's rip is Day-1, not a reversal, until XLK closes back above its ~\$180 TRADE / \$176 TREND levels. **What flips the regime:** a genuine crack in oil (WTI back below the low-70s) would take the air out of the #Quad3 inflation call and re-open the door to Tech; conversely, oil pressing the \$93 top plus a hot payrolls would harden #Quad3 and extend the rotation into Energy/value/defensives.

Positioning & themes

- **What's crowded / stretched:** levered-long AI, memory and high-beta momentum — the trades that just suffered their worst month since 2023 (TMT Memory -30.5%, momentum -30.9%). A Day-1 bounce doesn't de-crowd them.
- **What's working:** GARP software, Healthcare (+5.3% in Jul), REITs (+4.5%), and now Energy on the oil breakout — the #Quad3 winners.
- **Vol / credit setup:** VIX 15.77–20.56 with a bearish TREND (Hedgeye leans to lower vol), but the range top near 20+ is where hedges get paid if payrolls or oil surprises. HY (HYG) neutral, IG (LQD) bearish — credit is the confirmation to watch under a rotation.

Watch: The tell is whether the bounce broadens (breadth, cyclicals, small caps holding their bullish ranges) or narrows back into a failing mega-cap rip. Fade the latter.

Geopolitics — what's live

US–Iran / Strait of Hormuz is the dominant live risk. A 60-day ceasefire broke down into roughly two weeks of fighting; US strikes were put "**on hold**" around Jul 27 with talks looming, but the Strait-of-Hormuz crisis is unresolved and tankers are transiting through a contested zone. Any re-escalation is a direct oil spike — and therefore a direct #Quad3 accelerant.

Trade / tariffs: the Aug 1 reciprocal-tariff deadline keeps trade policy live, with new effective rates and fresh country deals (India ~18%, Taiwan ≤15%).

Prediction markets (verify live): Polymarket runs active books on the Aug 1 tariff outcomes, the September Fed decision, and 2026 US recession odds (which oscillated roughly **28–40%** earlier in the year). With the Fed having flirted with a hike, market-implied near-term cut odds are low — check live before citing a number.

Watch: The cleanest real-time gauge of the Iran risk is crude itself. A weekend Hormuz headline is the most likely source of a Monday Asia gap.

Asia setup — Monday open

Asia comes in off a violent mean-reversion. Korea's **KOSPI surged +17.9% Friday** — its largest single-day gain on record (Samsung +28%, SK Hynix +30%) — after crashing ~17% over the prior three sessions; Japan's Nikkei is still **-11.6% over the month** and only just flashing oversold. With Wall Street closing firm Friday, Asia should open with a risk-on bias — but Hedgeye's framing is explicit: this is **Day-1 of a bounce**, not a confirmed reversal (Hedgeye is short EWY).

Watch: The intraday tells: does KOSPI/Nikkei hold the morning gap or fade it; USD/JPY direction; and crude on the OPEC+/Hormuz headlines. A gap-up that fades by the HK afternoon is the momentum-unwind reasserting.

Beyond the markets — coming up

- **Policy & summits:** OPEC+ ministers (Sun Aug 2) headline the weekend; US tariff implementation dominates the trade-policy calendar.

- **Earnings culture-watch:** Disney (Wed) doubles as a read on parks, streaming and the consumer; McDonald's (Tue) is the classic value-consumer tell.
- **Sport & culture:** northern-hemisphere football pre-season and summer sporting calendar are in full swing; the European club season ramps later in August.
- **Note:** no first-tier space launch, index reconstitution or major product keynote is confirmed for this specific week at time of writing — verify closer to the day.

Sources & disclaimer

Sources: TheStreet, CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Washington Post (Friday market close); LiteFinance / Trading Economics / Forex Factory-style calendars and Kiplinger (economic calendar); Schaeffer's, CNBC, Kiplinger, TradingKey (earnings & week-ahead); Reuters, CNN, ABC News, Wikipedia (US–Iran / Strait of Hormuz); World Oil / Gate / Modern Diplomacy (OPEC+); Polymarket (prediction markets); Bank of England, RBA (central-bank schedules); Hedgeye (Early Look, MOMO Tracker, Quad Nowcast & Risk Range™ signals, Keith McCullough, 29–31 Jul 2026).

Verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting.

This report is a forward-looking market briefing for information only; it is not investment advice. Figures and event times were accurate to the sources at time of writing and are subject to change.